

Word family: **meaning / meanings / mean / meaningful / meaningless / meaningfully**

Base word: meaning

Related forms: mean, meaningful, meaningless, meaningfully

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “What I admire most is that he can take a small, everyday scene and turn it into a story with texture, humour, and **meaning**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **meaning** means **significance, importance, or a deeper idea that makes something more than merely an ordinary event or description**.

Mr. Wong can take an everyday scene and reveal something worthwhile or significant in it.

繁體中文： ** **某件事情所包含的較深層意義、重要性或值得人思考的價值，使它不只是表面的事件或描述**

中文翻譯：

> “...turn it into a story with texture, humour, and **meaning**.”

「.....把它說成一個有質感、有幽默感，而且有**深層意義 / 內涵**的故事。」

Here:

meaning = 一件事物所包含的深層意義、重要性或值得思考的價值

1. **meaning of + word/sign/sentence (字詞 / 符號 / 句子) — 意思 ; 含義**

This is the most basic linguistic meaning.

Meaning: The idea, information, or concept represented or communicated by a word, phrase, sentence, sign, symbol, etc.

Practice 1

> “What is the **meaning** of this word?”

「這個字的**意思 / 含義**是甚麼？」

Practice 2

> “I understood the sentence, but I wasn’t sure of its exact **meaning**.”

「我看得懂這句話，但不太確定它的準確**意思**。」

meaning = 字詞、句子、符號或訊息所代表或傳達的概念和內容

Common:

- * meaning of a word
- * exact meaning
- * literal meaning
- * figurative meaning
- * intended meaning

These belong to one linguistic/communicative sense.

2. **meaning** = significance/import/deeper value (事情 / 經歷 / 作品) — 意義；內涵；重要性

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The significance, importance, purpose, or deeper value contained in an event, action, experience, story, or other part of life.

Practice 3 — Original

> “He can turn a small, everyday scene into a story with texture, humour, and **meaning**.”

「他可以把一個日常小場面說成一個有質感、有幽默感，而且有**深層意義 / 內涵**的故事。」

Practice 4

> “The experience gave new **meaning** to her work.”

「這段經歷令她的工作有了新的**意義**。」

Practice 5

> “The story seems simple, but it has a deeper **meaning**.”

「這個故事看似簡單，但其實有更深層的**意義 / 內涵**。」

****meaning = 某件事所具有的較深層重要性、價值或值得思考的內涵****

This is genuinely different from merely asking:

> “What does this word mean?”

The first concerns ****significance****; the second concerns ****semantic definition****.

3. ****meaning = intention/message behind someone's words/actions (意圖 / 言外之意) — 意思 ; 用意 ; 意圖****

****Meaning**** can refer to what someone ****intends to communicate****, especially when the intended message is not completely explicit.

Practice 6

> “I understood the ****meaning**** behind his remark.”

「我明白他那句話背後的****意思 / 用意****。」

Practice 7

> “Her smile seemed friendly, but its ****meaning**** was difficult to read.”

「她的微笑看似友善，但背後的****含意****很難理解。」

****meaning = 說話、動作或表現背後想要傳達的意思、訊息或意圖****

This is related to linguistic meaning, but there is a useful distinction:

> ****dictionary meaning**** = what a word conventionally means

> ****someone's meaning**** = what that person intended to communicate

For database purposes, I would keep this as a separate practical sense because it requires a different mental focus: ****speaker intention****, not merely lexical definition.

4. ****meaning = purpose/reason for existence or activity (人生 / 活動) — 意義 ; 目的****

In more abstract contexts, ****meaning**** can refer to a purpose that makes life or an activity feel worthwhile.

Practice 8

> “She wanted to find greater **meaning** in her work.”

「她希望在工作中找到更大的**意義 / 價值**。」

Practice 9

> “Helping others gave his life a sense of **meaning**.”

「幫助別人令他的人生有了**意義和方向**。」

meaning = 令人生、工作或活動顯得值得、重要或具有目的感的價值

This is very closely connected to Meaning 2.

For database counting, I would **merge this with significance/deeper value**, because the broader semantic concept is:

> **what makes something important, worthwhile, or purposeful**

5. **meaning** = implication/consequence of a fact or development (含意 / 影響) — 意味 ; 代表的後果

Sometimes **meaning** refers to what a situation implies or what consequences should be understood from it.

Practice 10

> “The full **meaning** of the decision became clear later.”

「這項決定的真正**含意 / 影響**後來才變得清楚。」

Practice 11

> “Scientists are still discussing the **meaning** of the results.”

「科學家仍在討論這些結果所代表的**含意 / 意義**。」

meaning = 某個結果、決定或發展所暗示的重要內容、影響或後果

For core counting, I would usually merge this with Meaning 2 unless the database wants a particularly fine distinction between:

* **significance/value**

* **implication/consequence**

The Golden Manual tells us to merge when the same broad explanation naturally covers the cases.

Related form: **meaningful**

Meaningful has two especially useful branches.

**meaningful = important/significant (有意義的) **

Practice 12

> “They had a **meaningful conversation** about their future.”

「他們就未來進行了一次**有意義、值得深思的談話**。」

Practice 13

> “She wants to do **meaningful work**.”

「她希望從事**有意義、具有價值的工作**。」

meaningful = 具有真正的重要性、價值、目的或情感份量的

**meaningful = communicating something clearly (表達某種意思的) **

Practice 14

> “They exchanged a **meaningful look**.”

「他們互相交換了一個**意味深長的眼神**。」

Practice 15

> “He gave me a **meaningful smile**.”

「他給了我一個**別有含意 / 意味深長的微笑**。」

meaningful look/smile = 明顯帶有某種沒有直接說出口的訊息或含意

These uses are closely connected to the corresponding senses of **meaning**.

Related form: **meaningless**

Meaningless can mean lacking significance, purpose, or intelligible meaning.

Practice 16

> “Without context, the numbers are almost **meaningless**.”

「沒有背景資料，這些數字幾乎**沒有可理解的意義**。」

Practice 17

> “He felt that the routine had become **meaningless**.”

「他覺得那種日常生活已變得**沒有意義 / 沒有目的**。」

meaningless = 沒有清楚含義，或缺乏重要性、價值和目的的

The Chinese interpretation depends on which **meaning** sense is being negated.

Related form: **meaningfully**

Practice 18

> “She looked at him **meaningfully**.”

「她**意味深長地**看了他一眼。」

Practice 19

> “We need to engage **meaningfully** with the issue.”

「我們需要以**真正有實質內容和價值的方式**處理這個問題。」

meaningfully = 以帶有清楚含意、實質價值或重要性的方式

Important distinction: **meaning vs definition**

These overlap, but they are not identical.

meaning

= the concept or message represented by something

definition

= an explicit explanation stating what a word or concept means

For example:

> A word has a **meaning**.

A dictionary gives you its:

> **definition**.

So:

meaning = 意思本身

definition = 用文字解釋那個意思的定義

Important distinction: **meaning vs significance**

These overlap strongly in the figurative sense.

meaning

can refer to the deeper importance or value of something.

significance

usually emphasizes why something matters or what importance it has.

> “The meaning of the story”

can include its underlying message.

> “The significance of the discovery”

focuses more strongly on why the discovery is important.

So **meaning** is often broader and can combine:

- * message
- * value
- * purpose
- * significance

Important distinction: **meaning vs purpose**

meaning

asks:

> What significance or value does this have?

purpose

asks:

> What is it intended to achieve or why does it exist?

Example:

> “The purpose of the meeting is to make a decision.”

= 會議的目的

> “The meeting had special meaning for her.”

= 這次會議對她有特殊意義

So:

purpose = intended aim

meaning = significance/value/message

Important distinction: **meaning vs message**

message

is the particular idea that someone communicates.

meaning

is broader and can refer to:

- * lexical content
- * intended implication
- * deeper significance
- * purpose

A story may have:

> a clear **message**

and also:

> deeper **meaning**

The two overlap but are not synonymous in every context.

Important distinction: **meaning vs sense**

In vocabulary work, **sense** often means one particular established meaning of a polysemous word.

For example:

> “bank” has more than one **sense**.

Meaning is the broader everyday term.

This distinction is especially relevant to your polysemy database:

word = lexical item

meaning/sense = one semantic interpretation

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **meaning**
- * **mean**
- * **meaningful**

* **meaningless**

* **meaningfully**

However, **mean** itself has extensive polysemy:

* signify

* intend

* average

* unkind

* inferior/poor

* etc.

So under the Golden Manual, I would **not expand the full polysemy of *mean* inside this entry**. It deserves its own target if needed.

Useful expressions include:

* meaning of a word

* deeper meaning

* intended meaning

* meaning behind something

* meaning of life

* meaningful conversation

* meaningful look

* meaningless statement

The Manual says related forms should be included when educationally useful but accurately labelled rather than treated as extra meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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meaning — semantic content	字詞、句子、符號或訊息所代表或傳達的概念和內容；意思 / 含義
meaning — significance/value	某件事情所具有的較深層重要性、價值、目的或值得思考的內涵
meaning — intended message	某人的說話、動作或表現背後想要傳達但未必直接說出的訊息或意圖
meaning — implication/consequence	某個結果、決定或發展所暗示的重要內容、影響或後果；與「重要性 / 含意」高度相關
meaningful — significant	具有真正的重要性、價值、目的或情感份量的
meaningful — expressive	明顯帶有某種沒有直接說出口的訊息或含意的
meaningless	沒有清楚含義，或缺乏重要性、價值和目的的

| **meaningfully**

| 以帶有清楚含意、實質價值或重要性的方式

|

For your original sentence

> "...turn it into a story with texture, humour, and **meaning**."

The exact meaning is:

meaning = 一個故事所包含的較深層意義、重要性和值得思考的內涵

So:

> **a story with meaning**

= **一個不只是描述表面事件，而是具有深層意義和內涵的故事**

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely distinct core meanings** for **meaning**:

1. **semantic meaning — what a word, sign, or sentence signifies**
2. **significance / deeper value / purpose**
3. **intended or implied message behind words, actions, or behaviour**

I would merge **meaning as consequence/implication** into #2 or #3 depending on context rather than artificially creating a fourth core sense.